

Paypal-Facebook tieup

Facebook has announced a partnership with PayPal to use its technology for the purchase of self service ads and also the Facebook Credits currency

Typo money

Google earns approximately \$497 million per year due to URL typos according to a Harvard study

LCD Monitor

are most looking for. Unfortunately this also means this is a category subject to the most purple prose. Recently 22-inch monitors have been featuring 1920 by 1080 pixel resolutions — which is good for movies but not always the best option for someone looking for a desktop monitor. Fonts become finer, and although the densely packed pixels give the impression of far greater clarity and crispness this is actually misleading. Of the four monitors we tested, only one featured the de facto 16:10 aspect ratio with 1680 x 1050 pixels, the others had resolutions of 1920 x 1080 pixels.

BenQ's G2220HD is similar in looks to the 24-inch version with a similar name (the G2420HD) but owing to its smaller size it felt a little sturdier. The menu system is the same, which is mediocre. Intex's IT2203W was the only monitor with a resolution of 1680 x 1050 pixels. The stand feels flimsy and does not stop the monitor from moving at the slightest nudge. The bezel is narrow on the top and sides and broad at the bottom. The pale pink trim on the bottom bezel adds a bit of colour, to an otherwise black product. The controls work well for the most part and the menu is pretty simple even for a newbie. The Viewsonic

VX2233wm is a smaller version of the VX2433wm, the first two numbers denoting the screen size. It's built to a budget, with mediocre quality and the menu button indents are not at all visible on the front bezel making using the menu confusing and a hit and miss affair. Although the buttons have good feedback, they're too pointy — this hurts the fingerpads forcing use of nails. Samsung's SyncMaster B2230 has a very basic look, with a very mediocre stand. The touch controls for the menu are neat works pretty well, though it's still a bit away from the brilliant Alienware OptX. Button spacing is important and Samsung has handled this well. On a negative note, the buttons are impossible to use in the dark thanks to absence of backlighting.

Performance

The Samsung B2230 registers a lot of issues in the reverse text



APPLE 24-INCH LED CINEMA DISPLAY

The only display to ship with an S-IPS panel and the price reflects this — Rs. 52,000 is very steep, especially when you can buy a 27-inch monitor from Dell with the same panel for a lot less. But one look at this one will tell you it doesn't like to run in the rat race. Hell, it's not even on the same race-track — solid aluminium — this is a lethal weapon, and would bludgeon an ox with no apparent ill effects. There are 3 USB ports, but no display ports other than a measly mini display port connector that only Apple notebooks can accommodate.

We also feel this monitor would do better with the traditional CCFL backlighting, which we know is better for colour and contrast in comparison to LEDs and this hampers the performance. We got a contrast ratio of 565:1, which is kind of shy of what we expected. An S-IPS panel should have a contrast of at least 800:1 — Apple's backlighting technique is letting them

down. When paired with a MacBook you can enjoy extended desktop space and the superb resolution of 1920 x 1200 pixels feels so much better than the ultra wide 1920 x 1080 pixels. Surfing is fun. Movies are even more fun, thanks to the great colour rendition and viewing angles. This is a bright display — the average brightness is 190 cd/m2, pretty good but below par with other S-IPS panels that can have brightness levels nearing a retina-searing 350 cd/m2. If you've got the moolah to blow and have a MacBook Pro, go with the 30-inch version, which is pretty much sublime. If not, then the 24-inch is a decent buy, albeit a costly one. That being said, you could pick up a monitor with a Display Port connect and buy a display port to mini display port adapter cable. This would be a cheaper alternative that might even perform better, but we're pretty sure nobody makes aluminium-body LCD monitors!

test — green on cyan, cyan on green, magenta on red are problematic. In movies, for a dim screen the brightness is decent. Vertical viewing angles are bad, although no TN panel has good vertical viewing angles, Samsung took the cake here with some slightly worse scores. Banding with the colour blue adds a weird yellowish hue to the region where the banding occurs. Highlighting in movies is good for a TN panel. In games at the 50 per cent brightness and contrast settings, things are way too dark. Night scenes look even

darker and the highlighting looks artificial.

The Intex IT2203W had its own problems with DisplayMate's reverse text tests as red on magenta, yellow on white also, white on yellow, cyan on blue and blue on cyan are nearly illegible — this was one of the worst results for this category of test, surpassed only by its smaller sibling as you'll see later. There was noticeable moiré with the colour pink, and to a lesser extent with blue and red. Movies are good, apart from minor banding issues and there is a noticeable lack of variation in darker shades — no doubt owing to the mediocre

FORMULA Series Graphics Cards

Designed with Passion

Driven to Cool

13% Cooler!

Keep Cool with EAH5750 FORMULA

www.asus.in | For any enquires SMS **ASUS-Digit** to 567678 or 09220092200 | Toll Free No.: 1800-2090-365